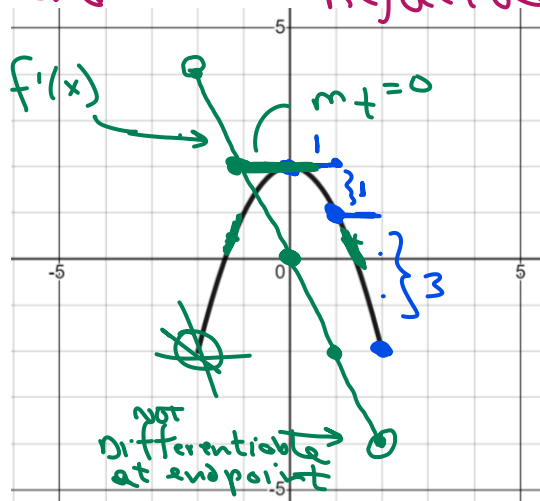


* parabola opens upward - slope is positive
 * " " " downward - " " negative

* 1 3 5 step
 pattern $\Rightarrow$ slope = 2
 2x2
 * 2 6 10 step
 pattern $\Rightarrow$ slope = 4

* And so on...



step pattern = 1, 3, 5 $\leftarrow$
 $\Rightarrow$ slope = -2
2x-1 = -2

$$y = ax^2 + bx + c$$

$\uparrow$
 1 3 5 $\Rightarrow a = 1$
 2 6 10 $\Rightarrow a = 2$
 -1 -3 -5 $\Rightarrow a = -1$

$$y = ax^2$$

$$y' = 2ax^{2-1}$$

$$= 2ax$$